



INSULIN PENS

A COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

PROCUREMENT & MARKET INTELLIGENCE BRIEF

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Landscape Map

Pharmaceutical ownership vs. technology sophistication

Scope: conventional and connected insulin-pen platforms. Owen Mumford's Aidaptus is shown as an adjacent auto-injector benchmark, not a direct insulin-pen competitor.

SMART / CONNECTED



SIMPLE / BASIC

DRUG MANUFACTURER → DEVICE / TECH SPECIALIST

Methodology: directional qualitative score based on connectivity, automated dose tracking, app/CGM integration and decision support. No market-share or unit-volume inference.

Notes on the Map

Two calls worth flagging explicitly

Eli Lilly — current position reflects Tempo transition

Lilly's Tempo Smart Button was a connected add-on for Tempo Pen, with automated insulin-dose data capture and app integration. Lilly's current materials indicate the Tempo platform is being wound down by the end of 2026; the map therefore reflects the current transition rather than Tempo's historical capability.

Owen Mumford — axis blind spot

Aidaptus is an advanced next-generation auto-injector platform, but its differentiation is primarily mechanical/manufacturing rather than digital connectivity. Its lower position on this axis reflects the framework definition — not a judgement on engineering sophistication.

Sources: Lilly Tempo materials; embecta Owen Mumford acquisition materials. Full source list on final slide.

Cost Architecture: What Changes with a Smart Pen?

Conventional prefilled vs. reusable connected architecture — a directional procurement lens

Mechanical / delivery	Core injection mechanism remains the main physical cost base; smart designs add complexity rather than replacing the delivery function.
Electronics & connectivity	Smart pens add electronics, memory/connectivity and related components that conventional pens do not require.
Software & data layer	Connected products add apps, data capture, integration and ongoing software support beyond the physical pen.
Validation & lifecycle support	Connected systems require broader device + software validation and can create additional support / maintenance requirements.
Use & replacement model	Reusable smart pens and disposable prefilled pens have different replacement cycles — so unit cost alone is not a like-for-like TCO comparison.

The smart-pen premium is better understood as a cost architecture than a single hardware markup: electronics, software/data, validation and lifecycle requirements add cost layers — while reusable vs. disposable design changes the replacement economics.

Why this matters

Public product materials support the feature differences above, but they do not disclose manufacturer BOM, COGS or category-level cost multipliers. This slide therefore avoids unsupported numerical estimates.

Where This Is Headed

2–3 year outlook

A “COEXISTENCE” MARKET, NOT A TAKEOVER

Working hypothesis: smart pens expand over the next 2–3 years, but conventional pens remain the scale segment.

DRIVERS

Automated dose capture, digital diabetes management and CGM/app integration create value for selected users — particularly where connected care can improve visibility without moving to an insulin pump.

BARRIERS

Affordability, reimbursement, device complexity and the need to adopt a supporting digital ecosystem can constrain broad replacement of conventional pens.

Strategic implication: the evidence points to segmentation rather than winner-takes-all adoption — conventional pens retain the accessibility/scale proposition, while smart pens compete where connectivity and clinical utility justify added complexity.

What This Tells Us

1

This is a coexistence market, not a takeover.

Conventional pens retain the accessibility and scale proposition; smart pens differentiate where connectivity and clinical utility justify added complexity.

2

Device innovation becomes more valuable when paired with commercial scale.

embecta's 2026 Owen Mumford acquisition explicitly combines Owen Mumford's device-design/manufacturing capabilities with embecta's global commercial and distribution infrastructure — illustrating the value of pairing engineering with reach.

3

Device and software expertise can create competitive advantage without owning the drug.

Medtronic's InPen combines automated dose logging, dose calculation, reminders and CGM-enabled functionality — showing how the delivery interface and software layer can differentiate a diabetes platform.

4

Owning both drug and device is a trade-off, not a pure win.

Pharma ownership can strengthen control of the patient ecosystem, but external partnerships remain important for connecting insulin dosing with CGM, apps and digital-care capabilities.

Sources

- Novo Nordisk — NovoPen 6 / Echo Plus smart-pen capabilities and app/CGM connections
- Medtronic — InPen product, dose calculator, dose logging and CGM / Smart MDI materials
- Eli Lilly — Tempo platform and Tempo Smart Button materials
- embecta — Owen Mumford acquisition announcement (Mar 19, 2026) and completion (May 15, 2026)
- Abbott — connected diabetes partnerships with Novo Nordisk and Sanofi; FreeStyle Libre + insulin-data integration
- *Analyst synthesis: competitive positioning and 2-3 year outlook are directional interpretations of the cited public evidence; no proprietary market-share or cost data used.*

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